

HCS HBs 2592, 2787 & 2834 -- VOTER QUALIFICATIONS

SPONSOR: Stinnett

COMMITTEE ACTION: Voted "Do Pass with HCS" by the Standing Committee on Corrections and Public Institutions by a vote of 15 to 0. Voted "Do Pass" by the Standing Committee on Rules-Legislative by a vote of 11 to 0.

The following is a summary of the House Committee Substitute for HBs 2592, 2787 & 2834.

Currently, a person on probation or parole for a felony conviction is not entitled to vote until he or she is finally discharged. A person convicted of a felony or misdemeanor connected with the right of suffrage is permanently barred from voting.

This bill allows a person on probation or parole to vote, unless they were convicted of a felony or misdemeanor connected with the right of suffrage.

This bill is similar to HB 617 (2025).

The following is a summary of the public testimony from the committee hearing. The testimony was based on the introduced version of the bill.

PROPONENTS: Supporters say that we should encourage individuals on probation or parole to feel they're being accepted and encouraged to participate in the governmental and community process. Reducing and getting rid of barriers encourages people to get involved. Civic understanding is a main goal of rehabilitation. This is a low-cost way to increase public safety. States which restore voting rights have reduced recidivism. The perspectives of individuals who have been incarcerated are important. Belief aids healing, growth, and trust, and returning the right to vote and the right to have a voice fosters that belief. Voting is a right, and it is the first, fundamental right of America. An effective justice system is one that rehabilitates and reintegrates individuals into society.

Testifying in person for the bill were Representative Stinnett; Americans For Prosperity; MO Voter Protection Coalition; MO NAACP; Khanika Harper, Justice For All; American Civil Liberties Union; MO Appleseed; Kay Park, League of Women Voters of

Missouri; Sheena Rogers, Show Me Justice For All and MO Justice For All; Responsive Government Action; Gwen Smith, Empower Missouri; and Brandon Ellington, Vanguard Consultants, LLC.

OPPONENTS: There was no opposition voiced to the committee.

Written testimony has been submitted for this bill. The full written testimony and witnesses testifying online can be found under Testimony on the bill page on the House website.